many more weapons than necessary to cause even the very high levels of damage demanded by the war plans.'[26]

As Daniel Ellsberg explains, the estimates provided by the Joint Chiefs *underestimated* the scale and scope of the devastation. They did not include the countries of the Warsaw Pact (Albania – until 1962 – Bulgaria, Czechoslovakia, East Germany, Hungary, Poland, and Romania), where another one hundred million people would perish. Nor did they count casualties from radioactive fallout in areas adjacent to the USSR and China (including India, Finland, Sweden, Afghanistan, Austria, and India, as well as Pakistan and Japan), where a further hundred million would die. And – depending which way the wind was blowing – radioactive fallout could result in a further one hundred million deaths in Western Europe, including among Washington's NATO allies. The US Joint Chiefs of Staff estimated that execution of the nuclear war plan in 1961 would kill some 600 million people. In addition, the cut-off point of six months was entirely arbitrary. Without industry, agriculture, medical care, law and order, societies would descend into pre-industrial (if not pre-agricultural) existence. Fatalities and other casualties would continue to rise.

This was a war for which the armed forces of the United States were fully prepared, as were those of the Soviet Union and the United Kingdom. US calculations involved only US nuclear weapons, as well as those British nuclear weapons included in the SIOP in accord with the joint UK-US strike plan. The joint strike plan was agreed on 1 October 1958, and assigned targeting of sixty-nine cities, seventeen air bases, and twenty air-defence installations to Bomber Command. There were also Canberra and Valiant aircraft equipped with US bombs (under an arrangement known as Project E) whose weapons remained in US custody, but which were intended for use by the RAF. These were assigned to, and targeted by, SACEUR. British nuclear bombers, deployed in the Far East, would also have been targeted on China under SEATO plans.[27]

The joint-strike plan was designed to coordinate US and UK attacks to avoid duplication of targeting, as well as 'fratricide' (where one nuclear explosion destroys another nuclear weapon) and other potential accidents. During the 1950s and early-to-mid sixties, SAC looked to its bombers